



◀ Monochrome MFDs:

BROTHER 7065DN

Price: ₹15,110

Monochrome MFDs

Whether for home offices or large corporations, MFDs are a staple at all workplaces. Their job is just to print, scan and fax documents at a fast and economical rate. The devices can range in complexity from bare bones, no-name boxes that just stay in a corner somewhere and tirelessly churn out pages or they can be flashy devices that take the form of office attractions for the more banal among us. Either way, these devices have a job to do and they must do it well.

There really can't be much innovation expected in this space, but Epson was one that surprised everyone with their Ink-tank based printers. They use ink to print on paper, unlike the toners used in most monochrome MFDs. Because of this, they're supposed to print at miniscule costs (20p per page, excluding cost of ownership). From what we've experienced in our tests, these printers are perfect for those looking for a printer that just prints, regardless of quality. They produce prints that are a bit smudgy when compared to their toner-based counterparts and hence don't win any Zero1 awards. Another reason the Epson printers fell short was for the price. The M200 sells for close to ₹14,000, which negates the cost advantage that the ink tanks provide, unless you're printing upwards of 30,000 pages that is.

Zero1 Winner Brother 7065DN

The 7065DN wins our Zero1 award for its ability to churn out excellent prints at a very reasonable cost



Ricoh Aficio SP200S

Price: ₹8,700



Brother DCP- 1511

Price: ₹9,090

without a stutter. The MFD is not too large and while we wouldn't call it compact, it's of a manageable size. The print quality was great, the LCD functional and the speed more than acceptable. The printer looks like it's built to last. When we calculated the cost of ownership of the device, we realised that it's strictly average when it comes to cost per page, but in the long term, if you print a lot and use the larger capacity drum cartridges, the cost comes down dramatically. Not enough to edge out Brother's own DCP-1511 (₹2.8 vs ₹1.7 per page), but enough to make it worth your while. Without the drum cartridges, as a regular printer, this was the most expensive printer to run, but not by much according to our tests.

Worthy Mentions

Brother DCP-1511

This unassuming little white box of a printer caught us off-guard with its cost of ownership, a piddling ₹1.7 per page. The reason for this incredible performance is the pricing for the toner and/or refill, ₹2,800 for 10,000 pages, which isn't bad at all, especially when coupled with a printer that costs about ₹9,090. The performance on offer was also quite good. The performance was a mixed bag and not as consistent as that of the SP200S (also mentioned here), but it's overall performance was good where it mattered. It scored very well in our point-size copy test (to test a printer's ability to scan and print teeny-tiny fonts) but did fall behind in our actual point-size printing and mixed document tests; the quality of the scanned images was also not too great. This is a great MFD to consider if you want one that is dirt-cheap to run.

Ricoh Aficio SP200S

This one is smaller than the 7065DN, but that doesn't mean it's scrimping out on features or performance. The device is as capable as any MFD we've had in our test and was particularly impressive in our black and white photo tests. The performance was quite good and it just barely managed to sneak ahead of the DCP-1511 at a slightly lower MRP.